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AI



Apple plans to
'significantly' grow AI
investments, Cook says

Apple on Thursday signaled that it's getting more serious about its plans to catch up in the AI race.

"We see AI as one of the most profound technologies of our lifetime. We are embedding it across our devices and platforms and across the company. We are also significantly growing our investments," CEO Tim Cook said on the Q3 2025 earnings call with investors. "Apple has always been about taking the most advanced technologies and making them easy to use and accessible for everyone, and that's at the heart of our AI strategy," he added.

IMAGE CREDITS: [DAVID PAUL MORRIS/BLOOMBERG](#)

Cook expanded on those comments on the call, noting that Apple was "reallocating a fair number of people" to focus on AI.

"We have a great, great team and we're putting all of our energy behind it," he added.

AI investments are also driving increased CapEx spending, which was up year-to-date, the company said. However, Apple pointed out that it still employed a hybrid model where it relies on third parties to make capital investments, which is why the figure won't grow exponentially.

Ahead of its call, the company shared in an interview with [CNBC](#) that it's open to M&A to accelerate its roadmap. The company told the outlet that it has already acquired seven

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companies this year. None was “huge” in terms of dollar amount, Cook said.

On the call, he added that Apple was making acquisitions at the rate of one every several weeks.

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Apple has been [criticized](#) for having been caught off guard by the AI era; it has announced a number of AI features that it has, so far, [failed](#) to ship. The company was even accused of [showing off an improved AI-powered version of Siri](#) that wasn't close to being ready to launch.

But [Apple has defended itself](#) by saying that it doesn't need to rush — that launching the wrong features or the wrong products just to be first would be a mistake. That's especially true if those products don't work as promised.

So far, Apple says it has launched more than 20 Apple Intelligence features, including visual intelligence, cleanup, and writing tools.

Later this year, Apple plans to launch AI features like live translation and an AI-powered workout buddy, but the more [personalized Siri's improvements have been delayed](#) to 2026. On the call with investors, Cook said the company was “making good progress” on the Siri update.

He also shared his thoughts on how AI may impact the iPhone business if new hardware were to emerge. For instance, Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg earlier this week suggested that AI glasses would be the form factor for interacting with the new technology, and [those without them would be left behind](#).

Cook, naturally, disagreed.

“It’s difficult to see a world where iPhone’s not living in it,” he said. “That doesn’t mean that we are not thinking about other things, as well, but I think that the [AI] devices are likely to be complementary devices, not substitutions.”

The exec declined to answer a question about which AI technologies it believed would ultimately be commoditized, saying that would give away part of its strategy.

Apple delivered better-than-expected iPhone sales and record revenue in Q3, which [saw its stock pop](#) in after-hours trading.

This article was updated after initial publication with more details from the earnings call.

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Three things we learned about Apple's AI plans from its earnings

Sarah Perez — 11:59 AM PDT · May 3, 2024

Apple CEO Tim Cook didn't give much away about the company's AI plans on [Thursday's Q2 earnings](#)

[call with investors](#), but he did confirm a few tidbits about how the tech giant plans to move forward with artificial intelligence.

Notably, his comments suggested that despite spending more than \$100 billion on R&D over the last five years, Apple isn't planning to spin up too many new data centers to run or train AI models. Instead, when it comes to AI, it will continue to pursue a "hybrid" approach, as it does with other cloud services, the company told investors.

AI will span devices beyond the iPhone

We also learned that Apple envisions AI as a key opportunity across the "vast majority" of the company's device lineup, not just the iPhone. While we've known this for some time — after all, Apple has been calling its [M3 MacBook Airls](#) the "best consumer laptop for AI" — the company shouted out on its earnings call how AI is being used across its products.

"I think AI — generative AI and AI — both are big opportunities for us across our products, and we'll talk more about it in the coming weeks. I think there are numerous ways there that are great for us, and we think that we're well-positioned," Cook said.

In addition to the MacBook Air, the Apple Watch uses AI and machine learning in features like its irregular heart rhythm notifications and fall detection, Cook noted. And when speaking about the enterprise, the CEO referenced big companies buying and exploring the use cases for Vision Pro, though he added that he wouldn't want to "cabin that to AI only."

"I would just say that we see generative AI as a very key opportunity across our products. And we

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believe that we have advantages that set us apart there,” Cook said.

AI won’t likely come up at the iPad event this month

However, customers itching to have an AI-powered Siri will have to wait a bit longer for that news, which has long been [expected to be announced](#) at Apple’s Worldwide Developers Conference (WWDC) in June. When Cook was asked Thursday about how AI will affect consumer demand for new devices like iPhone, he responded that, with regard to generative AI, we wouldn’t see any impact “within the next quarter or so,” but said he was “extremely optimistic” about the technology.

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Apple isn’t planning to make its bigger AI announcements before WWDC.

This discovery came about through a correction to [a CNBC news story](#), which had misinterpreted a statement Cook made to seemingly indicate there would be “big plans to announce” from an “AI point of view” at both upcoming events, including next week’s iPad event and WWDC in June. But as subsequent corrections show (likely after a lashing by a frantic Apple comms team), Cook had paused before saying “... from an AI point of view ...” which was the start of his next thought and not connected to Apple’s plans for both events.

The story was updated with this correction so people didn’t think AI news would be announced at the [iPad event scheduled for May 7](#). (You can read through the backstory [on the corrections here on 9to5Mac](#).)

While we didn’t expect to hear much if anything about AI until at least WWDC, this correction basically confirms that timing.

<https://techcrunch.com/2024/04/29/apple-ipad-event-2024-watch-apple-unveil-new-ipads-right-here>

Apple is taking a hybrid approach to AI investments

The biggest AI news, however, is something Cook said about Apple’s CapEx expenditures, which are funds spent on fixed assets, like servers and data centers, real estate and more.

While that’s not often the most interesting subject, this time the company’s response hinted toward Apple’s AI investment plans. As technology investor M.G. Siegler [pointed out on his blog](#), Apple CFO Luca Maestri had answered a question about generative AI’s impact on Apple’s historical CapEx cadence by explaining that Apple pursues a hybrid

model, “where we make some of the investments ourselves, in other cases we share them with our suppliers and partners ...”

Plus, he added, Apple does “something similar on the data center side. We have our own data center capacity and then we use capacity from third parties.”

“It’s a model that has worked well for us historically, and we plan to continue along the same lines going forward,” Maestri said.

Siegler interpreted this to mean that Apple won’t need to spend on CapEx because Apple isn’t planning to immediately build and train LLMs (large language models) on its own servers.

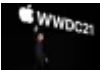
And, if you squint a little, it could also be another signal that Apple could be looking at third parties to power its AI services. As Bloomberg reported in April, [Apple has been holding discussions](#) with ChatGPT maker OpenAI and Google to power an AI chatbot coming in an iOS 18 update.

With Apple confirming that its CapEx wouldn’t be affected by its near-term AI plans, it’s likely that Apple is planning to forge some sort of deal with partners for AI services in addition to what it can handle on-device and by itself. Whether Apple eventually shifts the balance to utilize more of its own servers and data centers over time still remains to be seen.

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 sales for the second fiscal quarter, dropping from \$51.33 billion to \$45.96 billion, year-over-year. The slowdown was fueled, in part, by an 8% drop in China. Apple's slow adoption of AI versus competitors like Google and Microsoft likely played a role in consumers' decision to hold ...
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Apple WWDC 2024, set for June 10-14, promises to be ‘A(bsolutely) I(ncredible)’

 Apple SVP Greg “Joz” Joswiak just confirmed via the social media platform formerly known as Twitter that the company’s annual World Wide Developer Conference is set for June 10-14. In what is no doubt a nod to the company’s artificial intelligence ambitions, the exec is promising that the event will be “Absolutely Incredible.” Mark your ...
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Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [🦋](#) [@](#) [in](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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Apple acquires AI startup specializing in overseeing manufacturing components

Ivan Mehta — 9:06 PM PDT · March 14, 2024

IMAGE CREDITS:

NICHOLAS KAMM / AFP / GETTY IMAGES

Apple has added another AI startup to its acquisition list with Canada-based DarwinAI, which specializes in vision-based tech to observe components during manufacturing to improve efficiency, [Bloomberg](#) reported.

While Apple and DarwinAI haven't announced this deal, several members of the startup's team joined Apple's machine learning teams in January, as per their [LinkedIn profiles](#).

DarwinAI had raised over \$15 million in funding across various rounds from investors, including BDC Capital's Deep Tech Venture Fund, Honeywell

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Ventures, Obvious Ventures and Inovia Capital. [BDC Capital](#) confirms on its website that it has received an exit from DarwinAI, whereas [Obvious Ventures](#) has updated its portfolio to reflect that the startup has been acquired.

BDC Capital and Obvious Ventures didn't comment on the story at the time of writing. We have reached out to Apple for a comment, and we will update the story if we get a response.

As Bloomberg noted in its report, apart from helping with manufacturing efficiency, DarwinAI uses techniques to make AI models [smaller and faster](#). This could be useful for on-device generative AI features Apple hopes to introduce in iOS 18 this year.

Apple has lagged in releasing GenAI-powered features as compared to competitors like OpenAI, Google, Meta and Microsoft. In February, Tim Cook said the company [plans to introduce such features "later this year."](#)

"We continue to spend a tremendous amount of time and effort and we're excited to share the details of our ongoing work in that space later this year," Cook said during a quarterly earnings call with analysts.

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Last year the Apple CEO had [confirmed investment into GenAI efforts](#). Apple's job listings have suggested the company is [exploring infusing AI in multiple internal and external areas](#), including, Siri, developer tools and customer support.

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Ivan Mehta

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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Apple CEO Tim Cook says AI is a fundamental technology, confirms investments in generative AI

Sarah Perez — 9:01 AM PDT · November 3, 2023

Apple CEO Tim Cook pushed back a bit at the notion that the company was behind in AI on yesterday's Q4 earnings call with investors, as he highlighted technology developments that Apple had made recently that "would not be possible without AI." Specifically, the exec pointed to new iOS 17 features like Personal Voice and Live Voicemail as examples of its innovation with AI technologies. In addition, Cook confirmed Apple was working on generative AI technologies.

The features Cook called out aren't necessarily thought of as AI by consumers, and that may be by design. Cook suggested that Apple doesn't label the features as "AI" necessarily.

"We label them as to what their consumer benefit is," Cook said. "But the fundamental technology behind it is AI and machine learning."

Personal Voice, for example, is an accessibility feature designed to create an automated voice that sounds like you. It's intended for people who are

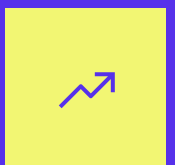
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losing their speaking ability due to various health conditions, including ALS. To use the feature, people first spend 15 minutes reading text prompts into the device's microphone. Then, using machine learning technologies, the audio is processed locally on their iPhone, iPad or Mac to create their own Personal Voice that sounds like them.

Live Voicemail, meanwhile, is a new [consumer-facing feature in iOS 17](#) that displays a live transcription of a voicemail as it's being recorded in real time.

"AI is at the heart of these features," Cook told investors. "And then, you can go all the way to the lifesaving features on the watch and the phone like fall detection, crash detection, ECG on the watch. These would not be possible without AI," he noted.

The Apple exec also confirmed that the company was developing generative AI technologies, saying "obviously, we have work going on." But he declined to share details, noting that Apple doesn't really do that.

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“But you can bet that we’re investing, we’re investing quite a bit, we’re going to do it responsibly and it will — you will see product advancements over time where those technologies are at the heart of them,” Cook added.

Apple, however, seems to have some catching up to do in terms of consumer-facing AI technologies, which have gained attention in recent months thanks to launches of tools like OpenAI’s ChatGPT and others from companies like Anthropic and Google.

The company has been said to be expanding its budget for building AI to “millions of dollars a day,” [according to The Information](#), and is employing multiple teams working on LLMs (large language models) as it attempts to put the tech to use. The hope is that one day users would be able to automate tasks via Siri, which today have to be manually programmed, for example via the Shortcuts app. In addition, Siri could gain new AI skills, like being told to turn the last few photos a user has taken on their iPhone and text it to a friend, the report said.

Bloomberg also noted the next version of iOS will include more AI capabilities, including changes to Siri and the Messages app, in terms of answering questions and completing sentences — similar to [Google’s autocomplete for Gmail](#). The outlet also suggested generative AI would come to Apple development tools, like Xcode.

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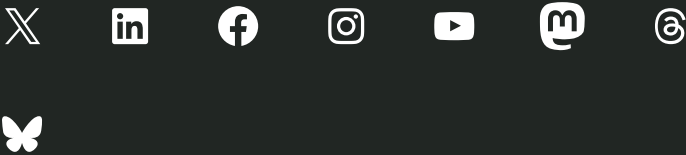
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